

October 22-25, 2026
Presented live from Herndon, VA

SPEEDGAMING LIVE 2026

THE NEW AGE

Event Guide

WHAT IS SPEEDGAMING LIVE?

SGLive consists of online and in-person elements. This event guide is centered more towards those attending the in-person event, but briefly will mention the online aspect here.

IMPORTANT LINKS
- EVENT WEBSITE: https://sglive.speedgaming.org
- SGLIVE DISCORD: Join the SGLive Server
- BUY TICKETS + CONTRIBUTE: https://matcherino.com/t/sglive26
- SG WEBSITE: https://speedgaming.org/
- SG SOCIALS: SG on X | BLUESKY | YouTube

SGL IN-PERSON:

The on-site event happens October 22 - 25, at the Hilton Washington Dulles Airport hotel in Herndon, Virginia. A ticket is required to attend and participate in a tournament. Tickets can be purchased from https://matcherino.com/t/sglive26 for $80 USD. Day passes are available for $40. Tickets will be sold at the check-in desk during the event if space permits.

Event Details:

Dates: Thursday, October 22nd through Sunday, October 25th, 2026
On-site event location: DoubleTree by Hilton Washington Dulles Airport
13869 Park Center Road, Herndon, VA 20171
+1 703-478-2900
Purchase Tickets | Hotel Info

Recommended: Arrival Wednesday, October 21st; Check-out Monday, October 26th. Please note that while the hotel does not charge a deposit when reservation is made, your card will be charged $50 USD per night upon check in for incidentals. This will be refunded upon check out.

Event Start/Finish

NOTE: All times listed on this document will be in local time for Virginia, USA, which is in the Eastern Daylight Time zone (EDT, UTC-4). For comparison, 9:00AM EDT is 6:00AM Pacific, 3:00PM Central European, 12:00AM Australian Eastern Time.

SGLive 2026 opens Thursday, October 22nd at 8:00AM EDT. If traveling from out of town, it's recommended to arrive and check-in on Wednesday, October 21st to ensure any delays will not cause you to miss the start of the events. The event ends the night of Sunday, October 25th, so check out date is recommended for Monday, October 26th.

Arriving to SGLive: By Plane

The closest airport is IAD (Washington Dulles International Airport). The hotel offers a free shuttle to and from the airport, contact the hotel by calling the number above to confirm the pickup time. DCA (Ronald Reagan National Airport) is located in Arlington, Virginia, about 30 miles east, however the hotel does not offer a shuttle there. The Washington Metro Area Transit Authority (WMATA) offers metro service at DCA Airport - take the BLUE LINE towards Largo to the Rosslyn station, then transfer to the SILVER LINE towards Ashburn. There you have two options - The INNOVATION CENTER station & Fairfax County Bus Route 983, which goes by the hotel, or you can stop at the DULLES INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT stop and use the hotel shuttle.

Arriving to SGLive: By Train

The nearest Amtrak train station is the Washington Union Station (WAS) in Downtown Washington, D.C.. From there, take the WMATA Metro's RED LINE towards Shady Grove for three stops to the Metro Center station, then transfer to the SILVER LINE towards Ashburn. There you have two options - The INNOVATION CENTER station & Fairfax County Bus Route 983, which goes by the hotel, or you can stop at the DULLES INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT stop and use the hotel shuttle.

Arriving to SGLive: By Car

The Hilton Washington Dulles Airport is located on Park Center Road in Herndon, Virginia, approximately 25 miles West of Washington, D.C. in Northern Virginia. You will want the McLearen Road exit off Virginia State Route 28 (two exits south of the Dulles Toll Road, two exits north of U.S. Route 50). Upon exit, you will want to take a left at the first traffic

signal, at Towerview Road (there's a Sheetz convenience store at the corner), then take the next left onto Park Center Road. Road signs will direct you to the hotel. The hotel is on your left.

ON-SITE TOURNAMENTS:

A Link to the Past Randomizer
Category/Settings: Open Boots with hurfydurfy love
Type of Bracket: Groups into Single Elimination Bracket
Registration Status: OPEN, must register on the Challonge by Tuesday, October 20th at 11:59PM EDT.
Tournament Rules

A Link to the Past (Vanilla)
Category/Settings: any%
Type of Bracket: Qualifier into Top 8 Bracket
Registration Status: OPEN, qualifier race times posted in the rules.
Tournament Rules

A Link to the Past Randomizer - Glitched
Category/Settings: HMG
Type of Bracket: Single Elimination Bracket
Registration Status: OPEN, async qualifier is available Friday, October 16th through 12pm Noon Thursday, October 22nd.
Tournament Rules (TBD)

Best of NES High Score Challenge
Category/Settings: High Score Challenge
Type of Bracket: High Score into final run to be determined
Registration Status: OPEN, check in over at the Best of NES room to play the high score challenge.
Tournament Rules (TBD)

Donkey Kong 64 Randomizer
Category/Settings: Season 5
Type of Bracket: Groups into Single Elimination Brackets
Registration Status: OPEN.
Tournament Rules

Final Fantasy Randomizer
Category/Settings: FFR Tournament Flags
Type of Bracket: Double Elimination Bracket
Registration Status: OPEN, must register with an FFR Admin by Wednesday, October 21st at 11:59PM EDT.
Tournament Rules

Majora's Mask Randomizer
Category/Settings: SGL
Type of Bracket: Double Elimination
Registration Status: CLOSED
Tournament Rules

Ocarina of Time Randomizer
Category/Settings: "SGL 2026 Tournament" preset (see the tournament rules)
Type of Bracket: Groups into Single Elimination Bracket
Registration Status: CLOSED
Tournament Rules

Super Metroid MAP Randomizer
Category/Settings: Community Race Season 4 (see the tournament rules)
Type of Bracket: Single Elimination
Registration Status: OPEN, enter on Challonge by Wednesday, October 21st at 5:59PM EDT
Tournament Rules

Super Metroid any%
Category/Settings: any%
Type of Bracket: Double Elimination
Registration Status: OPEN, must register on the Challonge by Wednesday, October 21st at 11:59pm EDT.
Tournament Rules

Super Metroid DASH Randomizer
Category/Settings: SGL26 (see rules)
Type of Bracket: Groups to Single Elim
Registration Status: OPEN.
Tournament Rules

Zelda 1 Randomizer
Category/Settings: 12TDBKH6mxLfnSz4T7ME4bcIaaUe9sE7UVmj7RA (check the rules document for a breakdown of the flags in use for the event)
Type of Bracket: Groups into Single Elimination Bracket
Registration Status: OPEN, must register on the challonge by Wednesday, October 21st @ 5:59pm EDT.
Tournament Rules

PRIZE POOLS:
All tournament prizes are funded by public contributions and from SpeedGaming. The prize pool board shows the total public contributions for each tournament. SpeedGaming also adds a bonus to each prize pool, as described below. SpeedGaming does not take any portion of the prize money.

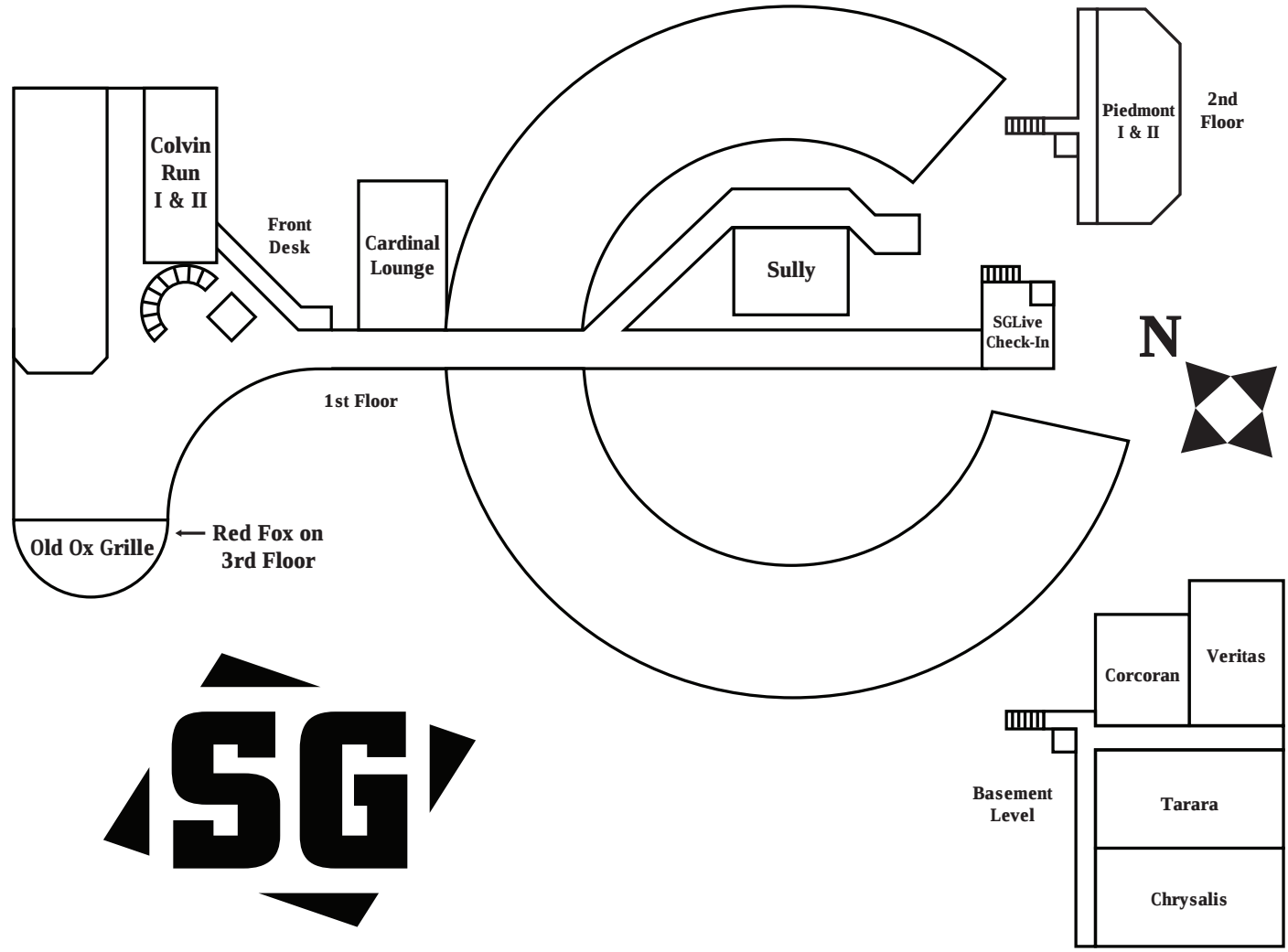
Contribute to a game's prize pool online. Write the name of the game in the comment (make sure you specify in-person or online in your comments). If the game has both an online and on-site tournament, your contribution will be split between the two unless otherwise specified in the comments. The prize pool board will be updated periodically. Prize pool contributions continue through the duration of the SGLive in-person event.

In addition to public contributions, all tournaments will receive prize bonuses from SpeedGaming. The bonus amounts can be seen on the prize pool boards. Deadlines for finalizing the prize bonuses: October 21st 11:59:59 PM Eastern Time

In addition to the cash prizes, winners will be awarded trophies provided by SpeedGaming.

Additional side tournaments and events will be offered by the community attending the event. Some examples include various gaming tournaments and races, card tournaments, board games and more. Check the community events and board game room channels on the SGLive Discord Server to find out more about the events taking place.

AT THE HOTEL:



Check-In

Wednesday 4:00PM to 10:00PM; Thursday-Friday from 10:00AM to 8:00PM EDT; Saturday 10:00AM to 4:00PM
1st Floor outside Fitness Center

Check-in will be handled during the above hours at a table set up outside of the event space where event goers will pick up their name badges, which are required to be visible during the duration of the event. Runners will verify through the QR Code sent by e-mail by Matcherino upon registration, or through presenting their photo ID to the check-in person on

hand. If you had not purchased admission, one can be purchased at that time for $40 USD (cash only) for a day pass, or $80 USD (cash only) for a full event pass.

For after hour check-in, please report to the ADMIN DESK inside the Tournament Room (in Sully) or ping an Admin.

Breakfast

Daily from 6:30AM to approximately 10:00AM Eastern Daylight Time.
OLD OX Wednesday, COLVIN Thursday-Monday 1st Room

Breakfast is buffet-style, and can include scrambled eggs, bagels, muffins, cereal, home fries, fruits/vegetables & pancakes/waffles or french toast. For beverages, water, coffee, juice, milk and tea is regularly offered. NOTE: The exact offerings of breakfast will vary from day to day. Any changes to the above schedule will be posted on the SGLive Discord Server

Board Games

Daily from 11:00AM until approximately Midnight Eastern Daylight Time.
TARARA room, Basement.

Board games and puzzles will be played here, including sessions of Blood on the Clocktower and Crockinole. The exact titles and times for get togethers will be mentioned in the #board-game-room channel on the SGLive Discord Server.

Casual Room

Daily from 7:00AM until Midnight Eastern Daylight Time
CORCORAN/VERITAS/CHRYSALIS ROOM, Lower Level

Play in pick-up races, side tournaments and special events not affiliated with SGLive here, or practice for tournament races. TV's are LCD screens with RetroTink connections as well as HDMI & analog inputs (see below for more equipment specs). One room will be reserved for the Best of NES's High Score attack.

Tournament Room

Daily from 8:00AM until Midnight Eastern Daylight Time Thursday-Saturday, 8:00am until 6:00pm Sunday
SULLY room, 1st Floor (near Check In)

All tournament matches not put on our restream stages will be played in this room, with the exception of the Best of NES events. **All tournament matches need to be scheduled during the open hours specified above unless prior approval is given by a SpeedGaming Live staff member for after hour play. This approval must be given by SGL staff, not by tourney admins.**

The Admin Desk will be positioned to the left of the doors, and will be staffed by SpeedGaming Live staff during the above hours. All tournament runners will check in here for their scheduled races, be seated by a Race Proctor, and then directed to the self-service PC to access their tournament seed (or seed # for Z1R races).

Once you have settled at your station, a Race Proctor will check the ROM hash codes to verify both runners are on the correct seed. Once ready, signal to the Race Proctor, who will quietly count down to begin play. After the end goal is satisfied as determined by the tournament's rules, raise your hand to signal to the Race Proctor you have finished. They will verify, and let your opponent know of your finish. In the event of a close finish, race proctor will notify admin desk for further verification or consultation of that tournament's admin body.

While most scheduling and volunteering to commentate and track races will be handled through our OnSite Tool, there will be a PC near the Admin Desk for runners to submit races to the schedule and for volunteers to sign up for duty.

The Tournament Room and the hallway outside is a QUIET ZONE. We ask runners once finished please proceed down the hall before discussing. Those who cannot keep conversations to a quiet tone will be asked to move away from the area.

Broadcast Room
Daily from 9:00AM until Midnight Eastern Daylight Time
PIEDMONT I + II, Second Floor (above the Fitness Center)

This is where matches assigned for broadcasting take place. Four SpeedGaming channel stages will be set up with seating for the audience, commentators and trackers overlooking the runners on a stage.

Runners will report here where the Broadcast Tech will direct them where to sit and set up their equipment. After doing so, they'll report to the Tournament Room to obtain their ROM for Randomizer Tournaments [those playing in a vanilla tournament can bypass this step].

Once the broadcast has begun, runners will confirm ready to the Broadcast Tech, who will count them down to begin the race.

Merchandise
Select SpeedGaming merchandise will be available for purchase from our partners at Tantrum Collectables at a table at SGLive.

OTHER HOTEL LOCATIONS
These venues are not an official part of the SGLive experience and we are not responsible for any fees incurred to you or your room as a result of usage of these services.

Cardinal Lounge
Cardinal Lounge offers a cool yet sophisticated ambiance and is the ideal place to start or end your evening. Speciality drinks are accompanied by tasty creative appetizers.

Old Ox Grille
Old Ox Grille features delicious local fare with a creative twist. Guests are greeted by friendly, professional staff in a laid-back setting. Start your day with the breakfast buffet or order from our menu, which features a wide array of satisfying selections.

Fitness
Personalized fitness for a balanced lifestyle while on the road. Outfitted with the latest generation of cardio and strength-training equipment, Hilton Fitness takes a personalized approach to help you feel your best during your stay. The indoor pool is available for when you want to swim laps or just relax

OFF-SITE POINTS OF INTEREST

MisterAngryPants's Restaurant Guide
Attendee MisterAngryPants has put together a list of some restaurant options in the Herndon/Reston/Chantilly area. Check it out: MAP's SGL Restaurant Big Board

Other Food & Grocery Options
There is a Sheetz convenience store around the corner from the hotel, at the intersection of Towerview Road and McLearen Road. The store also has made-to-order food and beverages.

There is a Taco Bell, Burger King and Popeye's located about ¾ miles away at the intersection of Centreville Road and McLearen Road. This is a part of a plaza that also has a Food Lion supermarket, an Indian Restaurant, a breakfast restaurant and a pair of pizza chains - 1 regional and 1 national. There is a CVS drugstore here as well.

One mile south (Next exit on VA Route 28) is a Wawa convenience store chain with sandwiches and other prepared foods and a Chick-Fil-A restaurant.

There are many more fast food & restaurant options, plus a Walmart and a Costco about 3 miles south (2 & 3 exits south on VA Route 28) in Chantilly, as well as more restaurant options a short drive north in the Reston Town Center area.

EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES

The nearest hospital is the Reston Hospital Center at 1850 Town Center Parkway. Urgent Care can be found at the CareNow Urgent Care, at 3456 Historic Sully Way in Chantilly, about 1 mile south (near the Wawa and Chick-Fil-A).

BEFORE YOU GO...

Bring Headphones

Players should bring headphones. All players should bring a pair of earbuds (1/8" wired). During streamed matches, to ensure sound isolation for randomizer races, players will listen to the game sound through earbuds, and we will provide over-the-ear headphones that go over the top of the earbuds which play white noise. We have some earbuds available for those who don't own any, but it's preferred for sanitary reasons that you bring your own.

For non-streamed matches players are allowed to use any kind of headphones, so you can bring non-earbud headphones too if you like. The monitors will have 1/8" headphone connectors that you can use, or you can connect headphones directly to your console/PC if that's what you prefer.

Bring a Console or Device to Play on Emulator

Players should bring their own console/controller/game or flash cart, or bring their laptop/PC if they play on emulator. If you're an emulator player who doesn't have access to a PC and can not borrow one for the event, please contact the organizers ahead of time. We may be able to provide a limited number of emulator setups, but we strongly recommend bringing your own or borrowing if you can.

Type of TV Monitors

All TV monitors in our practice and tournament rooms will be LCD monitors connected via a RetroTink (composite, component, s-video). If you want to play on any other kind of monitor, please bring it to the event. Please contact a SGLive Staff member if you need to store your TV.

Randomizer Tracking Methods

The allowed methods of tracking will depend on the tournament. For tournaments that allow programs to be used, it is the responsibility of the player to bring their own laptop/tablet/smart device/PC for tracking, and tournament admins will decide which tracking programs are allowed. Paper & pens/pencils may be provided at the admin desk as available.

SAFETY AND SECURITY

We have created a separate document outlining the SGLive Safety and Security Policies and what to do in case of an issue. Please make sure you read this in full and reach out to a SpeedGaming Live Staff Member in case you have any issues.

IN CLOSING

Thank you for coming to Herndon, VA to be with us at SpeedGaming Live 2026. We hope you have fun with whatever you do, whether it be hanging with friends, playing in tournaments, commentating or watching the madness occur. If you need anything, please feel free to reach out to us.

SGLive 2026 Staff: adirondackrick, clifford, darkmoonex, dani3883, Felix_TC, hurfydurfy, jamevil, synack, tsigma6

For any questions or to discuss the event please join us on our Discord server.